GEORGE OGOLA

SENIOR FULL-STACK SOFTWARE ENGINEER | AI/ML | DEVOPS

Nairobi, Kenya | +254 721-355598 | gogola89@gmail.com | github.com/gogola89 | linkedin.com/in/gogola89

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Software Engineer with 9+ years of experience designing, building, and deploying production-grade software. Experienced across full-stack development, AI and machine learning, backend architecture, and DevOps. Builds APIs and data-driven services with Python and Django, develops modern web interfaces with JavaScript/TypeScript frameworks, and has hands-on experience leading AI data annotation and model-training work for computer-vision applications. At 8teq Solutions, led backend architecture for services handling multiple daily requests at 99.9% uptime, while also leading a data science team working on face recognition and vehicle number-plate identification.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

Full-Stack Development: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, Django, Django REST Framework, React, Angular, Next.js, REST APIs

AI, ML & Computer Vision: Data annotation and dataset preparation, face recognition, vehicle number-plate identification, OpenCV, TensorFlow, AI model training and integration

Databases & Processing: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, SQL optimisation, Celery, RabbitMQ

DevOps & Cloud: Docker, Docker Compose, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Linux/Ubuntu, Nginx, AWS (EC2, S3, RDS, Lambda)

Architecture & APIs: REST, WebSockets, OAuth2, JWT, OpenAPI/Swagger, distributed services, caching, asynchronous processing

Quality & Observability: Pytest, Django TestCase, TDD, automated testing, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, Git, Agile/Scrum

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Backend and DevOps Engineer | Linux Solutions Company

Nairobi, Kenya | July 2026 – Present

- Contribute to the design, development, deployment, and maintenance of software systems, with a focus on backend services and reliable delivery.
- Work across development and operations workflows, including containerised environments, deployment automation, and application reliability.

Senior Software Engineer | 8teq Solutions Limited

Nairobi, Kenya | September 2019 – May 2026

- Led backend architecture and delivery of services handling multiple daily requests with 99.9% uptime.
- Led a team of data scientists responsible for annotating and preparing face and vehicle number-plate image datasets, then training AI models for face recognition and number-plate identification.
- Used OpenCV and TensorFlow in computer-vision workflows for dataset processing and AI model development/training.
- Designed and maintained REST APIs using Django REST Framework, including authentication, permissions, pagination, filtering, versioning, and OpenAPI documentation.
- Built asynchronous workflows with Celery and Redis for background jobs and data-processing tasks, reducing user-facing latency by 50%.

- Optimised PostgreSQL and MongoDB queries through profiling, indexing, ORM optimisation, and connection pooling, cutting average API response times by 65%.
- Introduced test-driven development practices and automated unit/integration testing, helping achieve 85% test coverage and reduce production bugs by 40%.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines with GitLab CI and GitHub Actions, automating tests, linting, and deployments and reducing deployment errors by 70%.
- Containerised Django applications with Docker and Docker Compose for consistent development and deployments to AWS environments.
- Applied authentication, rate limiting, validation, and API security practices; mentored five junior developers through code reviews and pair programming.

Backend Software Engineer | E-kraal Innovation Hub

Nairobi, Kenya | April 2018 – September 2019

- Developed Django REST Framework APIs for a video analytics platform, supporting concurrent processing of 50+ video streams with Celery and Redis.
- Built image-processing and feature-extraction data pipelines that processed thousands of records daily using optimised Django ORM operations.
- Automated deployment tasks with shell scripts and cron jobs, reducing manual deployment errors by 80%.
- Maintained Ubuntu Linux servers, backups, security hardening, and application monitoring; collaborated with frontend teams on API contracts and documentation.

Python Backend Developer | Linux Solutions Company

Nairobi, Kenya | April 2016 – April 2018

- Built Flask REST API endpoints for video-processing workflows, including authentication, request validation, error handling, and structured JSON responses.
- Designed SQLite and PostgreSQL schemas for video metadata, analytics results, and user configurations.
- Introduced Git branching and code-review practices to improve collaboration and reduce integration conflicts.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science | Egerton University, Nakuru, Kenya | August 2010 – May 2014

Dean’s List — Academic distinction.